



INVESTOR BRIEF · SEPTEMBER 2026

The customers already know my name.

A live air-filter store attached to my HVAC service company
and its 8,497 verified homeowners.

\$60,000 zero interest · principal only

• filterhero.net is live



WHY THIS ONE WORKS

I am not starting from zero.

Most online stores spend year one buying strangers. I start with 8,497 people who have already paid me.

8,497

Homeowners in my AC company's list

100%

Have an email and a verified street address

53%

Contribution margin

\$300

Total overhead per month

Filters get forgotten, and forgetting is expensive.

The coil ices, airflow collapses, the repair bill arrives. In South Florida the system runs eleven months a year, so it happens faster here.

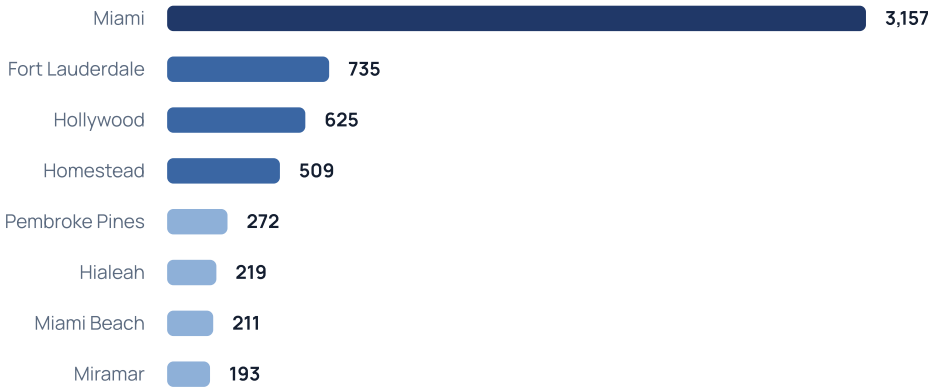
Replacement filter	\$9.99
Coil cleaning	\$150-\$400
Blower motor	\$450-\$1,200
Compressor	\$1,800-\$3,000+

Filters get replaced every 30 to 90 days, forever. The technician who services the system is the person who says which filter to buy. **That is me.**

8,497 homeowners. Already mine.

Exported from my AC company's database, cleaned and deduplicated. Not leads. People who let me into their homes and paid me.

WHERE THEY ARE



Plus Boca Raton, Coral Gables, Plantation, Pompano Beach and 40 more.

100%

Have an email on file

100%

Have a street address — direct mail works

7,380

Unique emails; the rest are shared households

0

Flagged do-not-service

8,472

Located in Florida

Two more doors nobody else has.

The service call

An online store competes for attention. A technician standing at the open return vent does not. The recommendation happens at the equipment, with the dirty filter in the customer's hand. Acquisition cost is zero — the visit is already paid for.

The building managers

Years of service work built direct relationships with building managers and maintenance supervisors from Boca Raton to Florida City, both coasts. When a unit fails, they call me. Routing filter orders through Filter Hero is a favor between contacts, not a cold call.



WHAT ONE PROPERTY IS WORTH

80 units × 4 changes per year	320 filters
Blended bulk ticket	\$11.25
Annual revenue	\$3,600

Most managers run more than one property, so a single relationship carries \$7,000–\$10,000 a year.

STATUS

Already built. Already live.

None of the \$60,000 pays for construction.

293

Sellable SKUs ready for checkout

153

Sizes available to add to cart

9,958

Sizes in the finder archive

38

HVAC brands, 166 OEM codes

Find it by size

Three dropdowns, no part numbers.

Find it by equipment

38 brands mapped to their filter sizes.

Filter Clock

Builds a replacement schedule and exports it to a calendar.

Quote anything else

Off-catalog and bulk sizes route to a staff quote pipeline.

EIGHT LIVE INTEGRATIONS

• Stripe

• Klaviyo

• Resend

• Supabase

• Railway

• QuickBooks

• Turnstile

• Fulfillment API

COST STRUCTURE

No team. No inventory. \$300 a month.

I studied marketing, AI, and automation, and I run all three myself. Strategy, copy, SEO, email, content, order flow, the storefront, the API, the admin, the CRM — all mine.

\$0

Agencies, freelancers, contractors

\$0

Paid advertising — all marketing is organic

Your capital goes to reaching customers, not to building something that already exists.

DROPSHIP — PRODUCT IS NEVER BOUGHT BEFORE IT IS SOLD

- × No inventory purchased up front
- × No warehouse and no lease
- × No employees and no payroll
- × No agency retainers

\$3,600 a year in total fixed cost.

A business that cheap to operate cannot run out of money and default. It can run at low volume indefinitely and keep paying.

UNIT ECONOMICS

Matched on price. Still 53% margin.

My pricing engine matches whoever is cheapest on that size – Filtrete, Filter King, FilterBuy – automatically, per size and per rating. Nobody undercuts me, because I am already at the floor. Then I deliver it in 2–3 days; the cheapest ticket in this market is usually a shelf you have to drive to.

PRODUCT (20×25×1)	COST	RETAIL	MARGIN
MERV 8	\$4.82	\$9.99	51.8%
MERV 11	\$6.05	\$13.49	55.2%
MERV 13	\$6.20	\$22.99	73.0%
Average, 199 costed 1" SKUs			58.5%

Those retail figures are not my markup – they are the lowest price found in the market, matched. After fulfillment and payment fees, contribution margin is **53%**.

COST VERSUS RETAIL, PER FILTER



Worst case, base case, best case.

Three channels stacked: the house list, commercial accounts, and organic search. Every input is printed so the math can be checked rather than trusted.

WORST CASE

\$46,520

Mail underperforms and the network yields few accounts. Milestones are missed, so **only \$20,000 is ever drawn.**

List conversion	2% · 170
Orders per year	2
Residential	\$23,120
Commercial (3)	\$14,400
Organic	\$9,000
Net profit	\$21,056

Full repayment of \$20,000

Month 24

BASE CASE

\$186,700

Direct mail performs to normal warm-list rates and the network converts a reasonable share of known properties.

List conversion	5% · 425
Orders per year	3
Residential	\$86,700
Commercial (10)	\$72,000
Organic	\$28,000
Net profit	\$95,351

Full repayment of \$60,000

Month 19

BEST CASE

\$512,300

The warm list converts at the rate a serviced relationship should produce and the commercial network opens at scale.

List conversion	10% · 850
Orders per year	3.5
Residential	\$202,300
Commercial (25)	\$240,000
Organic	\$70,000
Net profit	\$267,919

Full repayment of \$60,000

Month 9

Where the \$60,000 goes, and how it comes back.

USE OF FUNDS	AMOUNT
Direct mail to the list Three drops, each postcard printed with that home's filter size	\$18,000
Working capital Order float for net-30 commercial accounts	\$15,000
Organic and email scaling Sending tiers, content, landing pages	\$9,000
B2B seeding kits Samples for 50 target properties	\$7,500
Business setup Insurance, entity, accounting, reserve	\$5,500
Repayment reserve Guarantees the monthly floor during ramp	\$5,000
Total	\$60,000

Released in thirds, so you are never exposed to the full amount unless the business has proven it can sell.

TRANCHE 1

\$20,000

At signing

TRANCHE 2

\$20,000

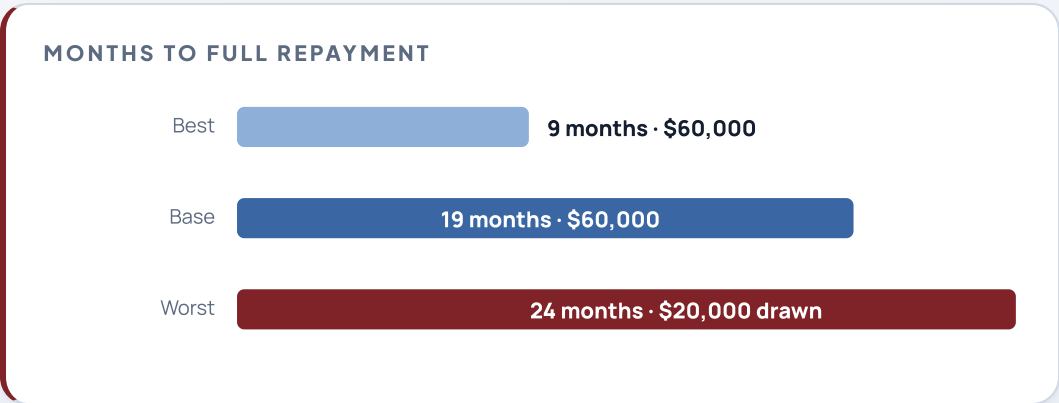
100 paid orders and 3 commercial accounts

TRANCHE 3

\$20,000

300 orders, 8 accounts, one profitable month

REPAYMENT	
Interest	None
Monthly payment	Greater of \$750 or 50% of net profit
Obligation ends	At the amount actually drawn
Reporting	Monthly, from Stripe and QuickBooks



RISK, HONESTLY

The real risk, and what contains it.

Marketing spend cannot be resold the way inventory can. If the mail campaign and the commercial outreach both fail, about \$27,000 is spent with nothing to liquidate. That is the honest downside.

1 · Tranche gating stops the bleeding

Most of the budget sits in tranches 2 and 3, which only release after paying customers exist.

2 · A \$300 cost structure

The business can run indefinitely at low volume and keep paying instead of defaulting.

3 · An independent backstop

My AC company keeps operating and covers the \$750 monthly floor.

THE ASK

\$60,000 zero interest · principal only

- A finished store, live and taking payment today
- 8,497 homeowners who have already paid me
- A commercial network built over years of service work
- Matched to the cheapest price in the market, still 53% margin
- Released in thirds, against proven milestones
- Repaid from profit, reported monthly



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